

WAAS

Wide Area Augmentation System is an air navigation aid which helps the Global Positioning System with the goal of improving its accuracy and availability

GPS Devices test

MapmyIndia Zx150 Deluxe	MapmyIndia Vx140	MapmyIndia Lx130
16,490	14,990	11,990
16.87	16.43	15.42
56.41	55.44	57.17
73.29	71.87	72.58
5 -inch	4.3-inch	3.5-inch
480 x 272	480 x 272	320 x 240
TFT LCD	TFT LCD	TFT LCD
98.5 x 78 x 17	122 x 78 x 12.5	99 x 74.5 x 12.5
142gms	165gms	122gms
Y	Y	Y
Y	Y	Y
Y	Y	Y
SiRF star III	SIRF Atlas IV	SIRF Atlas IV
8	8	8
Y	Y	N
Y	Y	Y
Y	Y	Y
1600mAh	1450mAh	900mAh
Win CE 6.0	Win CE 6.0	Win CE 6.0
5.5	5.5	5.5
3	5	6
6	4	4
49	49	49
N	N	N
N	N	N
7	7	7
7.5	7.5	7.5

based stands are provided for all.

The Lx130 is MapMyIndia's most basic PND, with just a basic navigation app and multimedia features that were common to all the other models too. MapMyIndia's maps are undoubtedly the most comprehensive of the lot, with maps of 902 cities and house-numbers in 13 cities. The application allows you to cycle through various viewplanes, from the basic 2D to various angles of 3D. During navigation, a bar on top provides information such as speed, distance to destination etc. You can customise the route on the basis of factors such as speed of route, type of vehicles and road types.

Specific locations and points of interest (POI) can be found directly on the map or by keying in a search string. POI database is very comprehensive, with 11 major categories and numerous

subcategories covering everything from entertainment to commercial locations, and tourism spots to religious places. You can also save your favourite places, routes and 'home' address, with the latter helpful to get home with the one click 'take me home' feature. The Lx130 also allows you to play audio/video or view pictures and documents.

Turn by turn voice navigation is available in 14 languages, including eight Indian languages. The higher-end models by the company include Vx140 and Zx150 Deluxe, progressively adding a feature. The Vx140 allows Bluetooth pairing with your phone, in addition to all features of the Lx130. Pairing your phone allows you to receive and make calls from the PND itself. The Zx150 is the high-end device, which has all the features of Vx150, plus a Video-in port that allows it to be used with a rear-view parking camera.

Maps are preloaded on Vx140 and Zx150, while Lx130 has the maps on the external card. Also, the Lx130 and Vx140

have a 2.5mm audio out,

HOW WE TESTED

In order to test the personal navigation devices (PNDs), we drove around the city, checking for things like resolution of the PND, accuracy of points of interests, user interface, ease of use and overall user experience with the device. We selected a route which had lots of turns, roundabouts and roads which were surrounded on either side by trees. The idea was to check the accuracy in navigation with all different kinds of road situations which could vary signal strength of the GPS unit.

We laid more stress on the performance, but the features were also taken into consideration. Voice navigation was given importance and PNDs with support for Indian languages had an edge over others. We calculated the score with an 80 : 20 ratio in favour of performance. High weightage was given to the user experience with operating the device while driving and detailing in the maps. Add-ons like media playback was noted down, but we did not give much weightage to it.

as compared the much more convenient 3.5mm in the Zx150 Deluxe.

Blaupunkt Lucca 3.5

Blaupunkt, the car audio system giant, has a very attractive looking PND with a range of slots on either sides. Travel Pilot Lucca 3.5 comes in a black body with silver sides. The presence of volume controller buttons on the front portion is thoughtful



Garmin nüvi 1460